me stretch my limits), my friend, my critic, my supporter, my partner in crime and so much more.

To my partner for life, Wing Commander Gautam Narain, the only reason I am able to juggle the different roles and responsibilities in my life.

To my lucky charm, my daughter Pragya, who brings zeal and freshness to my life every single day. I feel so blessed to have you.

—Flt Lt Gunjan Saxena (retd)

I was very young when the Kargil War broke out. I remember I used to see convoys of military transport vehicles going up and down NH-44 back in 1999, when I used to live at my grandmother's house in Udhampur. I would often ask my father about the movement of these large convoys. It was then that my father explained to me the concept of battles and wars, and told me that our country was fighting one. It was during these days that I heard the name 'Flight Lieutenant Gunjan Saxena' on one of the news channels. Little did I know that I would be writing about her one day. But when I started learning about military history back in 2016, I deemed it important to write about the war heroes of this country. 'Flight Lieutenant Gunjan Saxena' happened to be the first name that came to mind. Many a man has been glorified, and deservingly so. But I felt that very little was available about the contribution of women to this country's battles and wars. So the idea to co-write Gunjan Ma'am's autobiography was very thrilling.

At the outset, I would like to thank Flight Lieutenant Gunjan Saxena (retd) for trusting me with the responsibility of writing about her life. She has been very humble, kind and helpful, and her professionalism and discipline have helped us match all deadlines on time. Being co-authors of her autobiography is a singular honour, and it has been our endeavour to tell readers about how wonderful a person she is, besides being a woman in uniform, a loving daughter and a sister, a caring wife and a responsible mother.

My heartfelt thanks to my literary agent, Suhail Mathur, for pushing me to write this book and motivating me at every step.